

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE — IDEAS, SUBSTANCE, FORM AND MATTER, CAUSATION, ACTUALITY AND POTENTIALITY

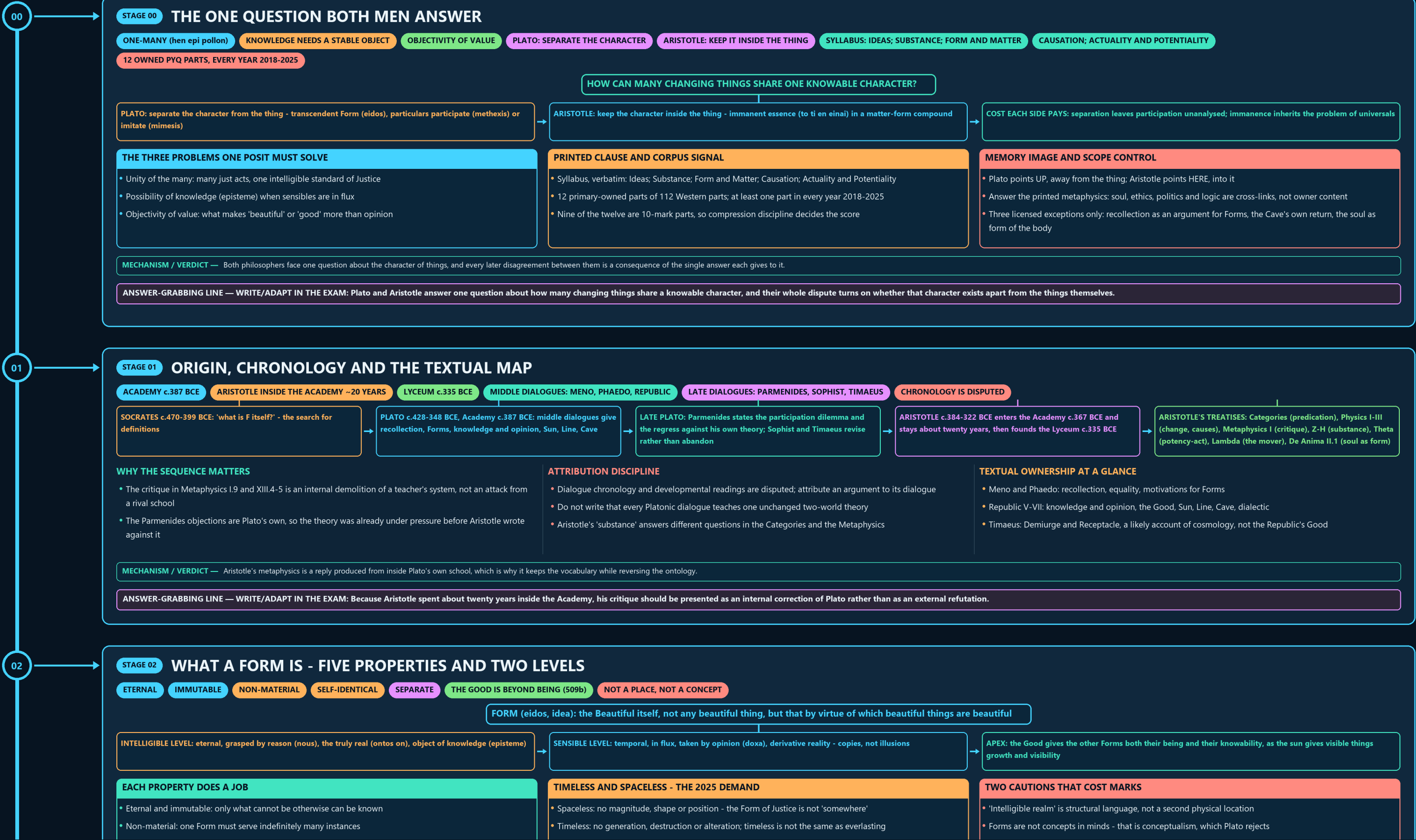
ONE QUESTION -> WHAT A FORM IS -> SUN, LINE, CAVE -> PARTICIPATION UNDER PRESSURE -> ARISTOTLE'S CRITIQUE AND IMMANENT REPAIR -> SUBSTANCE -> HYLOMORPHISM -> FOUR CAUSES -> POTENCY TO ACT -> COMPARISON AND ANSWER SPINE

Follow the cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final synthesis. Every stage uses a layout chosen for its own content: root-branch for problems, a timeline for chronology and for the potency-act ladder, matrices for the Divided Line and for substance, a process band for the Cave and for the four causes, a dialectic panel for participation under pressure, and paired columns for evidence boundaries. The grey E card is optional enrichment and never repairs a missing core point.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE - pending user review - repaired in place with all prior artifacts unchanged outside this topic

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aristotle's metaphysics is a reply produced from inside Plato's own school, which is why it keeps the vocabulary while redefining the ontology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Because Aristotle spent about twenty years inside the Academy, his critique should be presented as an internal correction of Plato rather than as an external refutation.

02

STAGE 02 WHAT A FORM IS - FIVE PROPERTIES AND TWO LEVELS

ETERNAL IMMUTABLE NON-MATERIAL SELF-IDENTICAL SEPARATE THE GOOD IS BEYOND BEING (509b) NOT A PLACE, NOT A CONCEPT

FORM (eidos, idea): the Beautiful itself, not any beautiful thing, but that by virtue of which beautiful things are beautiful

INTELLIGIBLE LEVEL: eternal, grasped by reason (nous), the truly real (ontos on), object of knowledge (episteme)

SENSIBLE LEVEL: temporal, in flux, taken by opinion (doxa), derivative reality - copies, not illusions

APEX: the Good gives the other Forms both their being and their knowability, as the sun gives visible things growth and visibility

EACH PROPERTY DOES A JOB

- Eternal and immutable: only what cannot be otherwise can be known
- Non-material: one Form must serve indefinitely many instances
- Self-identical: sensibles are F and not-F in different relations; the F itself never is
- Separate: the standard must not depend on what it corrects

TIMELESS AND SPACELESS - THE 2025 DEMAND

- Spaceless: no magnitude, shape or position - the Form of Justice is not 'somewhere'
- Timeless: no generation, destruction or alteration; timeless is not the same as everlasting
- Hence knowable but not perceivable: elucidate means derive this, not assert it

TWO CAUTIONS THAT COST MARKS

- 'Intelligible realm' is structural language, not a second physical location
- Forms are not concepts in minds - that is conceptualism, which Plato rejects
- Plato grants the sensible world derivative reality; he is not an illusionist

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The five properties are not a list of adjectives but a set of jobs, and the 2025 question is answered by deriving spacelessness and timelessness from them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Because a Form is non-material and self-identical it can occupy no position and undergo no alteration, and it is exactly that double negation which makes it an object of knowledge rather than of opinion.

03

STAGE 03 WHY FORMS ARE POSITED - THE FOUR ARGUMENTS

ONE-OVER-MANY ARGUMENT FROM KNOWLEDGE COMPREHENSION OF OPPOSITES RECOLLECTION (anamnesis) REPUBLIC V; PARMENIDES 132a PHAEDO 74a-75d; 72e-77a; MENO 80d-86c RECOLLECTION IS ONE ROUTE, NOT THE WHOLE

THE TWO LOAD-BEARING ARGUMENTS

- One-over-many (hen epi pollon): a common predicate applied to many requires one thing they share - Republic V, Parmenides 132a
- From knowledge: knowledge requires an unchanging object, the sensible world is in flux, so its objects are non-sensible universals - Republic V-VII

THE TWO SUPPORTING ARGUMENTS

- Opposites and relativity: a stick is longer than X and shorter than Y, but the Large itself is never small - Phaedo 74a-75d
- Recollection (anamnesis): we judge sensibles as falling short of a perfection never met in sense - Phaedo 72e-77a, Meno 80d-86c

SCOPE AND TRAP CONTROL

- Recollection is one supporting route, not Plato's complete epistemology; the Republic adds the dialectical ascent
- The soul enters here only as an argument for the Forms; the tripartite soul, justice and the philosopher-ruler are not owner content
- Forms are posited to explain stability and intelligibility despite change - explaining change is Aristotle's project

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The unity premise and the stability premise converge on the same posit, so one theory discharges two explanatory debts at once.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Forms are introduced to solve unity, knowledge and value together, and the theory should be judged by whether any rival account solves all three at once.

04

STAGE 04 THE DIVIDED LINE - FOUR STATES, FOUR OBJECTS, ONE SCALE

EIKASIA PISTIS DIANOIA NOESIS PRIMARY CUT: DOXA vs EPISTEME METHOD, NOT DIFFICULTY REPUBLIC VI 509d-511e

SEGMENT	STATE OF MIND	OBJECTS	METHOD
A (highest)	Noesis - intellection (nous)	The Forms, culminating in the Good	Dialectic: treats hypotheses as steps up to an unhypothetical first principle (arche anhypothetos), then descends using no images
B	Dianoia - thought	Mathematical objects	Uses visible things as images; argues downward from hypotheses it takes as known and gives no account of
C	Pistis - belief	Visible things: creatures, plants, artefacts	Ordinary perception and trust
D (lowest)	Eikasia - conjecture	Images: shadows and reflections (eikones)	Taking images for their originals

THE CUTS AND THE MNEMONIC

- Primary cut: D plus C is opinion (doxa); B plus A is knowledge (episteme)
- Mnemonic E-P-D-N matched to Images, Things, Mathematical, Forms
- The Sun analogy grounds the scale: the Good gives Forms knowability and being (Republic VI 507a-509c)

THE DISCRIMINATOR THAT DECIDES THE MARKS

- Dianoia and noesis differ by direction of argument and use of images, not by difficulty of subject matter
- A hard theorem is still dianoia; an elementary piece of dialectic is still noesis

OBJECTION AND SCHOLARLY ASIDE

- Objection: 'more real' is not a coherent comparative; Aristotle denies degrees of being at Metaphysics I.9
- Reply: 'more real' means more self-identically and unqualifiedly what it is
- Contested aside: Plato's own instruction makes the middle segments C and B necessarily equal in length

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The Line is one scale read twice, so that degrees of clarity in the knower correspond exactly to degrees of being in the known.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: What separates thought from intellection in the Divided Line is the direction of argument and the use of images, not the difficulty of the subject matter.

05

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06

STAGE 05

THE CAVE - ASCENT, CONVERSION AND THE COMPELLED RETURN

SHADOWS -> EIKASIA

FIRE AND ARTEFACTS -> PISTIS

REFLECTIONS -> DIANOIA

THE SUN -> NOESIS AND THE GOOD

PERIAGOGUE: TURNING THE WHOLE SOUL

KATABASIS: THE COMPELLED RETURN

POPPER 1945 ATTACKS THE LAST STEP

Prisoners chained from childhood see only shadows cast by a fire behind them - eikasia

→

One is released, turns, and sees the fire and the carried artefacts that cast the shadows - pistis

→

Dragged up the rough ascent, he bears at first only shadows and reflections in water - dianoia

→

Then the things themselves, then the stars, finally the Sun, and he infers that it governs all that is visible - noesis, culminating in the Good

→

He must go back down, will see badly in the dark, will be ridiculed and may be killed - the Socrates allusion

WHAT THE CAVE ADDS TO THE LINE

- Pain and compulsion: education (paideia) turns an organ of vision the soul already possesses
- Conversion (periagoge) of the whole soul, not the insertion of knowledge into an empty one
- The return (katabasis): the ascent creates an obligation, and Plato instructs at 517a-b that the image be applied as a whole

PRESUPPOSITIONS OF THE TRIAD

- Degrees of reality correlate with degrees of cognitive clarity
- The object determines the faculty - Republic V 476e-480a
- There is an unhypothetical first principle, or the ascent has no terminus
- The soul already possesses the capacity for noesis, hence recollection

THE WEAKEST LINK

- The step from having seen the Good to being entitled to rule does not follow by itself
- Popper attacks exactly here in The Open Society and Its Enemies, Volume I (1945)
- Popper's reading is widely regarded as polemical and is contested by Plato scholars

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because knowledge is a conversion of the whole soul rather than a transfer of information, an account of cognition turns into an argument about who may rule.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cave proves three things at once: that clarity tracks reality, that education is conversion rather than transmission, and that the one who has seen the Good must return.

07

STAGE 06

PARTICIPATION UNDER PRESSURE - DILEMMA, REGRESS, IMPOTENCE

METHEXIS AND MIMESIS

WHOLE OR PART - PARMENIDES 131a-c

SELF-PREDICATION

NON-IDENTITY

THIRD MAN - PARMENIDES 132a-b

CAUSAL IMPOTENCE SURVIVES EVERY ESCAPE

NAME COMES FROM ARISTOTLE'S REPORTS

OBJECTION 1 - THE PARTICIPATION DILEMMA

- Whole Form in each participant? Then it is separated from itself
- Only a part in each? Then a divided Form of Smallness would make its participant large
- Reply available: the dilemma assumes Forms behave like extended bodies, and a spaceless entity does not

OBJECTION 2 - THE REGRESS

- Premise 1, self-predication: the Form of F is itself F
- Premise 2, non-identity: the explaining Form must differ from what it explains
- A further Form follows at every stage; escape route is to deny self-predication
- The argument is Plato's at Parmenides 132a-b; the name comes from Aristotle's reports at 990b17 and 1039a2

OBJECTION 3 - THE ONE THAT SURVIVES

- A changeless, non-spatial, separated Form cannot be an efficient cause of change
- Participation and imitation remain metaphors without a causal mechanism
- Multiple participation is possible: the red chair is a chair through Chairness and red through Redness, and neither becomes a part of it

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Blocking self-predication saves the theory from the regress alone, because the explanatory gap between a separated Form and its participant remains unclosed.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The relation between Idea and world is not demonstrably inconsistent, but it is explanatorily empty, because a relation that cannot be specified cannot do explanatory work.

STAGE 07

PLATO'S CAUSAL REPERTOIRE - AND THE ACCURATE OBJECTION

PHAEDO: FORMAL EXPLANATION

REPUBLIC: THE GOOD GROUNDS BEING

TIMAEUS: THE DEMIURGE ORDERS

TIMAEUS: THE RECEPTACLE (chora)

THE GOOD IS NOT THE DEMIURGE

CHORA IS NOT ARISTOTELIAN MATTER

SAY: SEPARATED FORMS THEMSELVES

WHAT EACH DIALOGUE SUPPLIES

- Phaedo: a thing is beautiful because of Beauty and equal because of Equality - formal explanation without a mechanism of motion
- Republic: the Good grounds being and intelligibility and supplies an ultimate normative orientation
- Timaeus: a Demiurge orders becoming by looking to Forms as paradigms, and a Receptacle is the third kind in which becoming appears

THE LIMITS THAT MUST BE STATED

- The Demiurge crafts order and does not create the Forms or the Receptacle from nothing
- The Good is not simply a personal creator-God, and its relation to the Demiurge is contested
- The Receptacle is not straightforwardly identical with Aristotle's matter

HOW TO PHRASE THE OBJECTION

- Wrong and easily rebutted: 'Plato has no causes at all'
- Right and hard to rebut: separated Forms themselves explain neither motion, generation nor internal organisation
- The Timaeus pays the explanatory debt with a new entity rather than with an analysis of participation

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — Plato has more explanatory resources than Aristotle's summary allows, so the charge must be aimed precisely at what separated Forms cannot do.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's decisive complaint is not that Plato names no other cause but that separated Forms by themselves explain neither motion nor the organisation of a substance.

08

STAGE 08 ARISTOTLE'S FIVE OBJECTIONS AND THE IMMANENT REPAIR

THIRD MAN REGRESS

DUPLICATION

PARTICIPATION IS A METAPHOR

CAUSAL IMPOTENCE

NO ACCOUNT OF GENERATION

KEEP THE EIDOS, DELETE THE SEPARATION

Z.13 IS THE PRICE

METAPHYSICS I.9 AND XIII.4-5: five objections, of which only the regress needs self-predication

STACE'S REPORT: the Ideas are 'nothing but eternalized things of nature', and the theory places the essences outside the things themselves

THE REPAIR: form becomes the immanent what-it-is-to-be (to ti en einai) of this concrete composite

RETAINED: species and genus as secondary substances. DELETED: separate existence and the priority of the universal

WHAT THE REPAIR BUYS

- No regress: with no separation the Form-particular resemblance never arises
- Real causation: an immanent form is the actuality that the matter is potentially
- Generation explained: matter can lose one form and acquire another
- Unity: the composite is one thing, not two things joined

WHAT THE REPAIR COSTS

- Form must be intelligible and hence in some sense universal, yet Metaphysics VII (Z).13 denies that any universal is a substance
- Whether form is individual in each substance or species-level remains contested
- Prime matter, needed for radical generation, is a limiting posit whose textual standing is disputed

PRECISION THAT EARNS MARKS

- Never 'Aristotle rejected the Forms' - he rejects separated Forms and the priority of the universal
- Never 'Aristotle denies universals' - species and genus survive as secondary substances
- Objections two to five do not need self-predication, so the explanatory gap survives every escape route

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aristotle defeats separation rather than form, so Plato's motivating insight is answered rather than refuted and the difficulty simply changes address.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle keeps intelligible form and drops only its separation, converting a paradigm that could not cause anything into a principle that constitutes the thing it explains.

09

STAGE 09 SUBSTANCE - TWO QUESTIONS, FOUR CANDIDATES, ONE VERDICT

PRIMARY SUBSTANCE (tode ti)

SECONDARY SUBSTANCE

ESSENCE (to ti en einai)

Z.3 REJECTS BARE MATTER

Z.13: NO UNIVERSAL IS A SUBSTANCE

Z.17: WHY IS THIS MATTER A HOUSE?

TEN CATEGORIES ARE MODES OF PREDICATION

QUESTION	CATEGORIES 2a11 ff.	METAPHYSICS VII (Z)
What is being asked	Which things are substances?	What is the substance of a thing?
Criterion used	Logical-linguistic: the ultimate subject of predication	Causal-explanatory: what makes it be what it is
Answer given	The concrete individual (tode ti): this man, this horse	The form or essence (to ti en einai)
Status of the species	Secondary substance, less real than the individual	Essence is prior in being, definition and knowledge
Status of matter	Not discussed	Rejected at Z.3: neither separable nor a 'this'
The sting	Everything else is said of, or is in, a primary substance	Z.13 denies substancehood to any universal, yet form looks universal

Z.3 CANDIDATES AND VERDICTS

- Substratum as matter: rejected - what survives the removal of all predicates is not a 'this'
- Essence: accepted, the leading answer of Z.4-6 and Z.17
- Universal: rejected at Z.13. Genus: rejected, since a genus is predicated of many

FOUR READINGS - NAME AT LEAST TWO

- Different questions, therefore different answers - the safest exam line
- Developmentalist (Jaeger), depending on a disputed chronology
- Individual forms (Frede-Patzig) and species forms (Owen) - both contested

SUBSTANCE AND ACCIDENT

- Ten categories: substance, quantity, quality, relation, place, time, position, state, action, being affected
- Substance is; accidents belong to substance. Alteration is accidental change, generation is substantial
- The categories classify modes of predication and being, not physical components

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The Categories identifies the substances while the Metaphysics identifies substance-hood, so a change of answer follows a change of question rather than a change of mind.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The individual remains what exists in the primary way, but what accounts for its being the individual it is, is its form - and Aristotle denies that substance has a single sense.

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10

STAGE 10

HYLOMORPHISM - MATTER, FORM, PRIVATION, PRIME MATTER

MATTER (hyle) IS RELATIVE

FORM (morphe) MAKES IT ONE

COMPOUND (synolon)

PRIVATION (steresis)

SOUL AS FORM OF THE LIVING BODY

PRIME MATTER IS A LIMIT CONCEPT

2025 BOUNDARY ON 'EVERYTHING'

EVERY SENSIBLE NATURAL SUBSTANCE IS MATTER INFORMED BY FORM - a compound (synolon), not two objects joined

MATTER IS RELATIVE: copper and tin become bronze, bronze becomes the statue; there is no bottom layer without arrangement

CHANGE = underlying subject + acquired form + prior privation; the unmusical man persists, acquires musicality, loses the privation

ACCIDENTAL CHANGE keeps the substantial form; SUBSTANTIAL GENERATION installs a new one and a new substance exists

THREE JOBS, THREE TOOLS

- Matter, form and privation give the structure of change
- Potentiality and actuality give the modal transition
- The four causes give the reason why this determinate process occurs

PRIME MATTER, HANDLED SAFELY

- A limiting posit of matter considered without any determinate form, never existing independently
- Criticism: an unintelligible abstraction. Reply: a limit concept required by radical generation
- Do not present it as an observed stuff, and do not equate it with the Receptacle

THE 2025 QUANTIFIER AND ITS LIMITS

- The claim holds of sensible substances, where the soul is the form of the living body (De Anima II.1)
- It does not extend to accidents considered apart from their subject
- Nor to mathematical abstractions, nor to the Unmoved Mover, which is pure form without matter

MECHANISM / VERDICT — One pair of correlative principles explains unity, change, persistence and definition, which is why physics, biology and psychology form a single enquiry for Aristotle.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Matter and form are not two things joined but two correlative principles of one substance, and that is what dissolves the two-world problem without abandoning essence.

11

STAGE 11

FOUR CAUSES AND INTERNAL TELEOLOGY

MATERIAL: MADE OF WHAT?

FORMAL: WHAT IS IT?

EFFICIENT: BY WHAT?

FINAL: FOR WHAT?

ALL FOUR OPERATE SIMULTANEOUSLY

DIRECTEDNESS, NOT DESIGN

MILL EXCLUDES FINAL CAUSES BY DEFINITION

STATUE: bronze, the shape of Hermes, the sculptor, to honour the god - the artefact is a teaching case where intention really is present

ACORN: acorn matter, oak-form, parent and nutrition, the mature oak - in organisms formal, efficient and final causes converge

DEVELOPMENTAL CHANGE: matter supplies the potential, an efficient cause initiates, a telos directs, a formal cause specifies what it becomes

IDENTITY AS PROCESS: the same substantial form states what the thing is and is the actuality its potential moves toward

WHAT 'CAUSE' MEANS HERE

- Aristotelian causation includes reasons as well as causes - Stace records that all four operate simultaneously in every production
- Mill's cause as the invariable and unconditional antecedent excludes final causes at once
- The four are aspects of one explanation, never four events and never four agents

TELEOLOGY DEFENDED AND LIMITED

- 'Nature does nothing in vain' - De Caelo, Politics, De Partibus Animalium - asserts regularity, not deliberation
- The acorn reliably becomes an oak and never a cat; that reliability is what the final cause names
- Decisive against teleology in physics; functional explanation survives in biology as adaptation and organ-function

OBJECTION AND REPLY ON IDENTITY

- Objection: defining a process by its completed form reads the end back into the beginning
- Reply: a potentiality is a capacity of this material under these conditions, not a guarantee of completion
- Verdict: consonant, but the consonance is purchased with internal teleology

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The four causes are four complementary answers to one question about one thing, which is why an explanation giving only the efficient cause is for Aristotle incomplete.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's reasons for developmental change are the four causes working together, so that change is the actualisation of matter's potentiality under the direction of a final cause.

12

STAGE 12

POTENCY TO ACT - CHANGE, PRIORITY AND PURE ACTUALITY

DYNAMIS

KINESIS

ENERGEIA / ENTELECHEIA

PHYSICS III.1 (201a10)

BEING-IN-POTENTIALITY

PRIORITY IS NOT TEMPORAL

UNMOVED MOVER MOVES AS FINAL CAUSE

BLOCK OF WOOD: the capacity to become a table - dynamis, an ontological capacity and never a probability

THE CARPENTER WORKING: the actuality of the potential precisely as potential - kinesis, Physics III.1, 201a10

THE FINISHED TABLE: the capacity fulfilled - energeia as activity, entelecheia as completed state

PARMENIDES AND HERACLITUS BOTH ANSWERED: a third status, being-in-potentiality, denies their shared dichotomy

TERMINUS: the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality, moving as the beloved moves the lover - Metaphysics XII (Lambda).7

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PRIORITY OF ACTUALITY IN THREE SENSES

- In definition: 'potentially F' presupposes what it is actually to be F - hence potentiality is indefinable
- In time at species level: only an actual oak produces acorns
- In substance: the end is what the becoming is for
- Concede openly that in an individual's own history the potential state precedes

FORM OVER MATTER IS THE SAME PRIORITY

- Wood does not tell us what a table is; the functional structure does
- Metaphysics VII (Z).17 asks why this matter is a house, and answers with the form
- Form is actuality considered structurally; actuality is form considered modally

THE MOVER, BOUNDED CORRECTLY

- Pure actuality with no unrealised potentiality; thought thinking itself (noesis noeseos)
- It attracts as an object of desire and thought; it does not push, create or conserve
- Retained only because pure actuality completes the causal and modal system, not as a theology survey

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aristotle does not refute the Eleatic argument but denies its dichotomy, adding a third ontological status that makes becoming intelligible without creation from nothing.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — **WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Change is the actuality of the potential precisely as potential, so becoming is neither a leap from absolute non-being nor the sheer dissolution of stability.

13

STAGE 13
COMPARISON, GRADED VERDICT AND THE ANSWER SPINE

SEPARATED PARADIGM vs IMMANENT ESSENCE
ONE AXIS: is the form inside the thing? Every further contrast follows from the answer

UNIVERSAL vs INDIVIDUAL
PLATO buys stability, objectivity and knowledge, and forfeits causation

THE GOOD vs THE UNMOVED MOVER
ARISTOTLE buys causation, unity and generation, and forfeits a clean account of universals at Z.13

DEFEATS SEPARATION, NOT FORM

STEPHANUS AND BEKKER

RULING IN LINE ONE

THE PROBLEM OF UNIVERSALS
ROUTE: directive, definition, argument, example, objection, reply, graded verdict - 10, 15 and 20 marks change only the number of items

THE MATCHED CONTRASTS

- Location of form: transcendent against immanent. Most real: the universal against the individual (tode ti)
- Knowledge: dialectical grasp against ascent from sense to universal form and causes
- Causation: paradigm and the Good against four causes and internal teleology
- Highest principle: the Form of the Good against the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality

DIRECTIVE DECODER

- Elucidate means derive; explain the Cave means map it and include the return
- Differentiate means one axis; examine the critique means arguments plus replies
- Four causes means one worked example; actuality means solve Parmenides first
- Substance means the Categories against Z with two named readings; critically evaluate means a ruling in line one

CITATION AND FINAL TRAPS

- Plato by Stephanus, Aristotle by Bekker; give 'Book VII (Z)' once in both conventions
- Report as testimony: the Third Man name, the intermediates at Met. I.6, the scholastic 'rational animal', Popper 1945
- Never: Forms as concepts in the mind, four causes as agents, the Mover as efficient cause, potentiality as probability

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The dispute is not settled in antiquity but converted into the problem of universals, and every later realism and nominalism debate inherits its terms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — **WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:** Aristotle transforms Plato's insight rather than erasing it, because removing separation solves causation while leaving the intelligibility of form as an unfinished problem.

E

EXTRA
SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT - ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH
INTERPRETIVE DISPUTES

- Does the Third Man refute all Forms or only a self-predicative version? Vlastos, Fine and developmental readings differ
- How can there be one science of being qua being? The focal-meaning reading refers every sense back to substance
- Is Aristotelian form individual or species-level? Frede-Patzig against Owen, with a mixed reading available

THIRD MAN AFTER THE STOCK REGRESS

FOCAL MEANING OF BEING

INDIVIDUAL vs SPECIES FORM
SOURCE-CRITICAL REFINEMENTS

- Degrees of being: Plato's Line presupposes them and Metaphysics I.9 denies them
- The middle segments of the Line are necessarily equal, a fact Plato never comments on
- Several familiar Platonic doctrines reach us only through Aristotle, who is summarising a view he is about to refute

DEGREES OF BEING

EQUAL MIDDLE SEGMENTS

ARISTOTLE'S PLATO IS A REPORTED PLATO
CONCEPTUAL LINKS, NOT CURRENT AFFAIRS

- Rationalism inherits and redefines the substance vocabulary; Kant targets both Platonic and Aristotelian metaphysics
- Nyaya-Vaīśeṣika's God as efficient cause is the natural contrast with a mover that acts as a final cause
- Samkhya's doctrine that the effect pre-exists in the cause parallels potentiality, and must not be pushed further

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer and should be used only for a single evaluative clause after the complete core has been written.